



TUESDAY

APRIL 15, 2025
SHAWWAL 17, 1446



Scan for
our social
media

Sharjah fire: Owner and manager face legal action

SHARJAH
BY AGHADDIR ALI
Senior Reporter

The owner and manager of the Sharjah high-rise, which killed five residents will face legal action for serious safety violations, according to a top official.

Following a detailed inspection, officials uncovered multiple violations, including overcrowded shared living spaces and dangerously overloaded electrical systems — conditions suspected to have contributed to the fire.

Brigadier Sami Khamis Al Naqbi, Director General of Sharjah Civil Defence said, “If the building manager and owner are found responsible for these breaches or for failing to meet safety standards, strict legal measures will follow.”

Yesterday, residents were allowed to return to their homes, with the exception of those on the 42nd floor — where the fire originated.

FULL REPORT ON P2



SPORT

**Dubai win
set the stage
for McIlroy's
Masters
success | P15**

UAE ranks second globally in combating tax evasion

COUNTRY RANKS FIFTH WORLDWIDE IN EFFICIENCY OF TAX POLICIES

DUBAI
BY KHITAM ALAMIR
Staff Reporter

The UAE has ranked second worldwide in combating tax evasion, and fifth globally in the efficiency of tax policies, according to the latest annual report from the IMD World Competitiveness Centre in Switzerland.

The announcement came during a Cabinet meeting yesterday, chaired by His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, held at Al Watan Palace in Abu Dhabi.

Shaikh Mansour Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Vice-President, Deputy Prime Minister and Chairman of the Presidential Court; Shaikh Maktoum Bin Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, First Deputy Ruler of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Finance of the UAE; and other officials were present at the Cabinet meeting.

Tireless efforts

Shaikh Mohammad attributed the tax success to “the tireless efforts of dedicated Emirati teams,” which have resulted in the registration of 520,000 companies under the corporate tax system and 470,000 entities under the VAT system.

During the meeting, the Cabinet reviewed the latest developments related to the country’s efforts to build the UAE’s tax system, a vital pillar supporting the nation’s financial sustainability and reinforcing our global competitiveness.

Shaikh Mohammad emphasised that a robust and efficient tax framework is fundamental to completing the UAE’s economic



WAM

■ Shaikh Mohammad, Shaikh Mansour and Shaikh Maktoum during the Cabinet meeting yesterday.

44 INTERNATIONAL AGREEMENTS APPROVED

The UAE Cabinet also approved 44 international agreements across the economic, developmental, and governmental sectors.

It also authorised the commencement of negotiations on investment protection and promotion agreements with 30 countries worldwide.

“The UAE will continue to build strong investment and economic ties with all friendly and brotherly nations, and we will continue to pursue an open economic approach, one that has firmly established its global competitiveness and strengthened its position as a strategic hub connecting East and West,” Shaikh Mohammad said.

— K. A. A

520,000

firms have been
registered under the
corporate tax system

that reflects the maturity and adaptability of our economic landscape,” the UAE Vice-President added.

“We extend our sincere appreciation to the entire team whose dedication continues to shape a world-class tax system, helping to secure the financial sustainability of the UAE’s ongoing development journey.”

infrastructure for the future, noting that its effectiveness serves as a key indicator of the economy’s strength and resilience.

“Over recent years, a new culture of tax awareness and compliance has taken root across sectors, an achievement

BUSINESS

**UAE jewellers
seek new ways
to attract
price-stunned
shoppers | P5**

NATION

**New agreement
to offer global
scholarships
to Emirati
graduates | P4**

HEALTH

**The right food
and drinks on
your plate could
be the key to
better sleep | P8**



INDIA

**Fugitive
diamantaire
Mehul Choksi
arrested in
Belgium | P14**

Subscribe In print and online

www.store.gulfnews.com
www.gulfnews.com/subscriptions
Tel: 600 587 234
E mail: circ@gulfnews.com

PRICE
UAE: Dh 5.00
Bahrain: BD 0.500
Oman: RO 0.500
India: Rs 40.00
S. Arabia: SR 5.00
Pakistan: Rs 100.00

Soft Toys & Battery Operated Toys

Ceramics

Gifting & Baskets

Nests, Bunnies & Chicks

Painting kits

Bunny Ears Headbands, Sunglasses & Hair clips

SHOP MORE, SAVE MORE

Wooden Decor

Easter Eggs & Carrots

NOW OPEN AT REEM MALL & MARINA MALL ABU DHABI

Abu Dhabi • Ajman • Al Ain • Dubai • Fujairah • Ras Al Khaimah • Sharjah

Daiso_Japan_UAE
DaisoJapanUAE
daisome.com
6005 DAISO